Introduction

Introduction I

Most reproducible-research tooling treats a document as a linear stream: a manuscript is sections of prose, rendered top to bottom. A newspaper is the opposite — a deliberately *non-linear*, spatial artifact, in which a reader's eye is guided by a hierarchy of headline sizes, by rules and gutters, by the placement of a photograph and the interruption of a pull quote. Building one programmatically is therefore an unusually demanding test of a layout system, and an unusually legible demonstration when it succeeds.

`template_newspaper` exists to be that demonstration within the research template. It is the third canonical exemplar, joining `template_code_project` (a computational pipeline) and `template_prose_project` (a manuscript-quality pipeline). All three share one directory contract and one orchestration pipeline; they differ only in what they render.

The design follows a single principle: **content is data, the engine is the press.** An edition is a small set of YAML files under `content/` — a masthead manifest and one file per page, each declaring its stories, boxes and figures. The engine in `src/newspaper/` reads that data and renders it; it contains no copy and, outside a single typography module, names no fonts. Producing a different paper — a school gazette, a conference daily, a neighborhood broadsheet — is an edit to the data, not the code.

The remainder of this manuscript describes the engine's architecture (Section 2), its typography and figure generation (Section 3), and how the artifact is produced and verified reproducibly (Section 4).